Unit 4 — A Trip to Scotland

Track E · Klasse 7 · Niveau E

Learning objectives I

- *I can understand a short station announcement and pick out destination, platform, and direction.*
- *I can read a short narrative about Scotland and identify two things that surprised the visitor.*
- *I can use the past perfect (had + past participle) to order events in a story.*

Lead-in I

Aisha's aunt sent two postcards from Scotland. One showed a green hill with a single cow on it. The other showed a castle in fog. On the back, the aunt had written, in her thin handwriting, *"Pictures lie. Bring a coat."* Aisha put the postcards on the fridge and looked at them every morning before school. By the end of the week, the cow on the hill had become a kind of friend.

Vocabulary I

- eat
- see
- take
- fly
- go
- have
- start
- arrive

Reading I

Listening — *Welcome to Edinburgh Waverley*
Listen to the announcement with closed books.
”Ladies and gentlemen, this is the train manager. We are now arriving at Edinburgh Waverley, our final stop. Please take all your belongings with you. The exit for the city centre is on the right; for the bus station, take the lifts on the left. Travellers heading to the Highlands should change here for the 14:05 to Inverness, platform four.”
Quick listening check:

- Where is the city-centre exit?

Reading II

- Where is the bus-station exit?
- What time is the Inverness train, and from which platform?

Reading III

Reading — *Postcards and Hills*
Frances had only seen Scotland on postcards. The hills, in the postcards, were always green and the sky was always grey. The hills, in real life, were also green, but the green changed every twenty minutes — sometimes a tired green, sometimes a green so bright it looked wet. The sky was less grey than expected. It was more like an enormous changing mood. By the end of the first day, Frances had stopped trying to predict the weather and had started enjoying it instead.

Language focus — past perfect
We use the **past perfect** (*had* + past participle) when one past event happened **before another past event**. The earlier event takes the past perfect; the later event takes the simple past.

Reading IV

- *When Frances arrived in Edinburgh, the sun had already set.* → first the sun set, then Frances arrived.
- *By the time we found the hotel, the rain had started again.* → first the rain started, then we found the hotel.

Reading V

Forms.

Verb	Past simple	Past participle
eat	ate	eaten
see	saw	seen

Verb	Past simple	Past participle
take	took	taken
fly	flew	flown

Reading VI

Verb	Past simple	Past participle
go	went	gone
have	had	had

Verb	Past simple	Past participle
start	started	started
arrive	arrived	arrived

Reading VII

Word order trap. *Already* sits between *had* and the past participle: *He had already eaten.* — not *He already had eaten.*

Vocabulary cluster — UK travel

Word	Meaning
platform	the stretch of track-side concrete you board from
connection	a second train or bus you change to

Reading VIII

Word	Meaning
return / single (BrE)	round-trip / one-way ticket
Highlands	the mountainous north of Scotland

Word	Meaning
Lowlands	the southern, flatter part of Scotland
loch	a lake (Scottish English)

Reading IX

Word	Meaning
firth	a long sea inlet

Practise I

Niveau G — controlled
A. Past simple or past perfect?

1. When we _____ (arrive) at the station, the train _____ (already / leave).
2. After she _____ (read) the postcard, Aisha _____ (put) it on the fridge.
3. The bus driver _____ (smile) when he _____ (see) our tickets.

Practise II

B. Match the announcement to its purpose.

Announcement	Purpose
1. ”Mind the gap.”	a. tell people where to change train
2. ”Change here for Inverness.”	b. final destination

Announcement	Purpose
3. ”This is the last stop.”	c. safety on the platform

Practise III

Niveau M — productive
C. Rewrite using past perfect for the earlier event.

4. The film started. We arrived at the cinema. → By the time we ___ , the film ___ .
5. Aisha put the postcards up. Then her cousin came to visit. → When her cousin ___ , Aisha ___ .
6. The rain stopped. Then we left the hotel. → After the rain ___ , we ___ .

Practise IV

D. Two-line dialogue. Imagine you are at Edinburgh Waverley. Write a two-line dialogue between you and a member of staff, using one direction word (*right / left / lift / platform*) and one connection time.

Your turn I

Reading-to-speaking. In pairs, role-play a short conversation between Frances and a friendly stranger she meets in Edinburgh on her first day. Cover:

- *one thing about Scotland that surprised her,*
- *one question she still has,*
- *one piece of advice from the stranger.*

Two minutes each direction.
For Niveau M, ask one of the speakers to use the past perfect at least once: *"I had imagined Scotland as one big rainy place …"*

Reflect I

- I can understand a short station announcement and pick out three details.
- I can read a short narrative about Scotland and explain two surprises.
- I can use the past perfect to put two past events in order.

Further reading / listening I

- BBC Travel — *Scotland*. https://www.bbc.com/travel/destination/scotland
- VisitScotland — accessible introductions for young readers. https://www.visitscotland.com
- Robert Louis Stevenson, *Kidnapped* — short extracts as follow-up reading for keen Niveau-M learners. https://www.gutenberg.org/ebooks/421